CONSUMER COMPLAINTS RESPONSE ANALYSIS

Findings, interpretation, and recommendations based on the analyst's work

Report detail	Description
Source dataset	Consumer_Complaints(1).xlsx; Data worksheet
Rows in source file	62,516 complaint records
Analysis focus	Complaint volume, response timeliness, recurring issue categories, and potential operational/data-handling improvements
Scope note	This report presents findings already identified in the analyst's SQL and Power BI work. It does not claim that suspected root causes have been proven.

Executive summary

The analysis reviewed 62,516 consumer complaint records and focused on response timeliness and recurring complaint categories. The overall figures previously calculated from the dataset were 58,619 timely responses, 2,403 untimely responses, and 1,494 records marked in progress. Among records with a known Yes/No timeliness value, the untimely response rate was approximately 3.94% and the timely response rate was approximately 96.06%.

At product level, the analyst's results identified Debt collection (6.44%) and Credit reporting, credit repair services, or other personal consumer reports (6.32%) as the highest untimely-response rates among the listed products. By count, Checking or savings account had 867 untimely responses and Credit card or prepaid card had 689. These are different prioritization views: rate highlights relative frequency among known responses, while count highlights the number of untimely responses.

Within Debt collection, identity-theft complaints involving credit card debt showed 372 complaints, 61 untimely responses, and a 16.53% untimely rate among 369 known responses. This is a lead for further investigation, not proof of the cause of delays. The report therefore recommends two routes: (1) operational investigation and easier account-related processes, supported by complaints about opening, closing, and managing accounts; and (2) data consistency and data handling, supported by complaints about incorrect information and identity-theft-related debt disputes.

1. Objective and scope

The objective is to use the complaint analysis to identify recurring complaint themes and response-timeliness patterns, then formulate practical recommendations. The report preserves the analyst's findings and distinguishes observed complaint patterns from possible explanations that require validation.

- Complaint volume and response timeliness by product.
- Recurring issue and sub-issue categories highlighted in the Power BI dashboard.
- Debt-collection sub-issue and sub-product combinations, with special attention to identity theft.
- Two recommendation routes: operational ease and data consistency/data handling.

2. Data and calculation approach

The supplied workbook contains 62,516 rows and fields including Product, Sub-product, Issue, Sub-issue, Company response to consumer, and Timely response?. The timeliness field is interpreted as follows: Yes = timely response; No = untimely response; In progress and blank values are not treated as known Yes/No responses.

Metric	Calculation / interpretation
Total complaints	Count of complaint records.
Known responses	Records where Timely response? is Yes or No.
Untimely response count	Records where Timely response? is No.
Untimely response rate	Untimely responses ÷ known Yes/No responses.
Timely response rate	Timely responses ÷ known Yes/No responses.

Rates are calculated only over known Yes/No responses, so records marked In progress or blank are excluded from the rate denominator. Complaint volume is not a customer-normalized rate and does not by itself establish company error, customer harm, case duration, or resolution quality.

3. Overall response performance

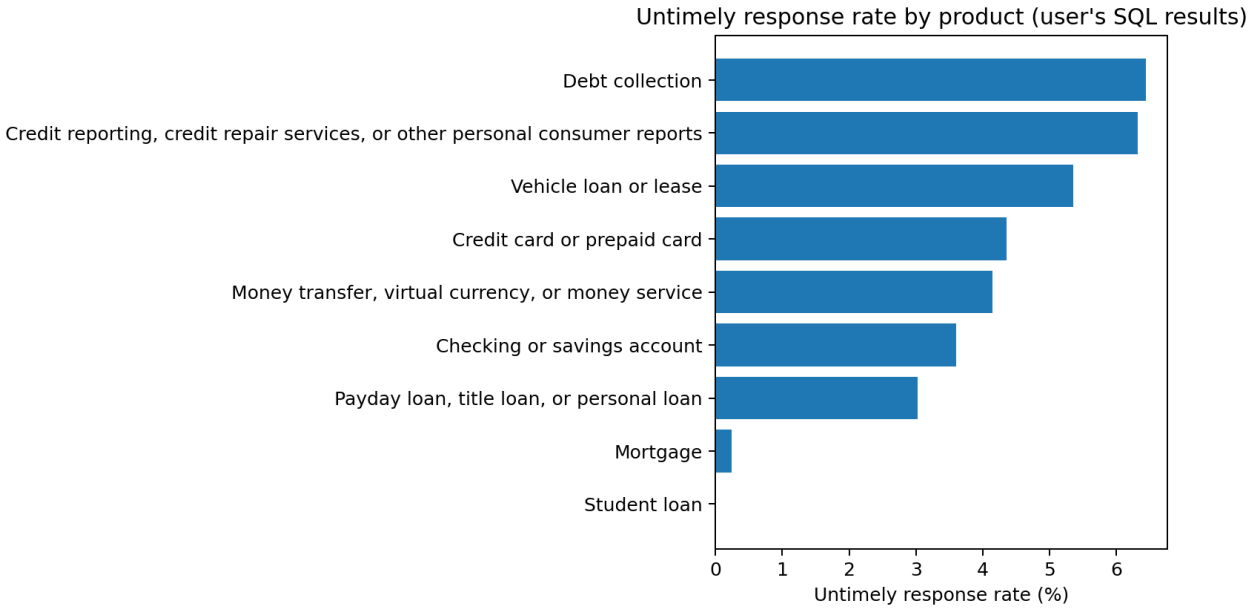
Overall measure	Count / rate
Total complaint records	62,516
Timely responses (Yes)	58,619
Untimely responses (No)	2,403
In progress	1,494
Timely response rate among known Yes/No	96.06%
Untimely response rate among known Yes/No	3.94%

Interpretation: the overall untimely-response rate is relatively small compared with the timely-response rate, but the product and sub-issue breakdown shows that the overall figure does not describe every category equally. The rate should be read together with the absolute number of untimely responses.

4. Product-level findings

The table below reproduces the product-level results identified in the analyst's SQL work. Total complaints, untimely responses, known responses, and untimely rate are shown together to prevent a high rate from being mistaken for a high absolute volume.

Product	Total complaints	Untimely	Known Yes/No	Untimely rate
Debt collection	2,736	173	2,687	6.44%
Credit reporting, credit repair services, or other personal consumer reports	7,710	475	7,520	6.32%
Vehicle loan or lease	633	33	617	5.35%
Credit card or prepaid card	16,197	689	15,785	4.36%
Money transfer, virtual currency, or money service	3,453	140	3,384	4.14%
Checking or savings account	24,814	867	24,104	3.60%
Payday loan, title loan, or personal loan	333	10	331	3.02%
Mortgage	6,601	16	6,555	0.24%
Student loan	39	0	39	0.00%



Key findings from the analyst's results: Debt collection has the highest listed untimely-response rate (6.44%), followed closely by credit reporting (6.32%). Checking or savings account has the largest untimely-response count (867), followed by credit card or prepaid card (689). Student loan has only 39 known responses, so its 0.00% rate should not be interpreted as strong evidence of consistently better performance.

5. Complaint themes shown in the Power BI dashboard

The dashboard's Top Issues visual highlights the following categories, in displayed rank order: managing an account; incorrect information on a report; problem with a purchase shown on a statement; closing an account; and trouble during the payment process. The Top Sub Category visual highlights checking account, general-purpose credit card or charge card, credit reporting, conventional home mortgage, and other banking product or service.

Dashboard visual	Categories highlighted
Top Issues	Managing an account; Incorrect information on your report; Problem with a purchase shown on your statement; Closing an account; Trouble during payment process
Top Sub Category	Checking account; General-purpose credit card or charge card; Credit reporting; Conventional home mortgage; Other banking product or service

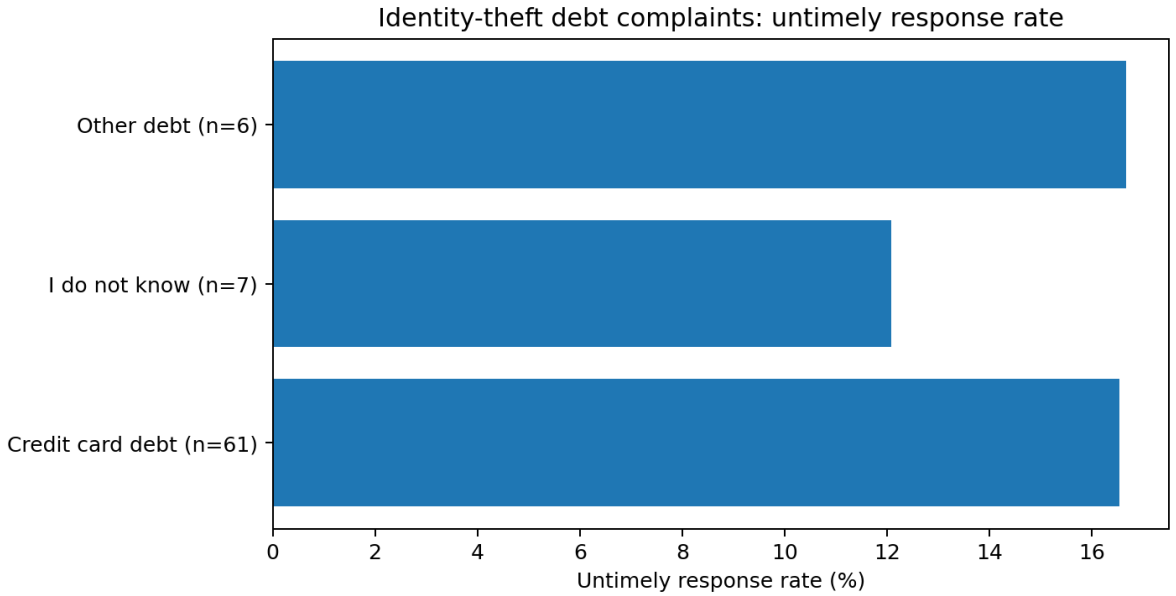
These categories support examining both account-related operations and information accuracy. The screenshot does not provide exact values for every bar, so no exact complaint counts are assigned to these issue labels in this report.

6. Debt-collection drill-down

The analyst's sub-issue/sub-product breakdown identifies identity theft, debts consumers say are not theirs, incorrect amounts, insufficient verification information, and debts reported as already paid among the visible higher-count or higher-rate groups.

Sub-issue	Sub-product	Total complaints	Untimely	Known Yes/No	Untimely rate
Debt was result of identity theft	Credit card debt	372	61	369	16.53%
Debt is not yours	Credit card debt	348	23	347	6.63%
Attempted to collect wrong amount	Credit card debt	135	9	133	6.77%
Debt is not yours	I do not know	120	8	119	6.72%
Didn't receive enough information to verify debt	Credit card debt	181	8	180	4.44%
Debt was result of identity theft	I do not know	60	7	58	12.07%
Debt was paid	Credit card debt	126	6	122	4.92%
Debt was result of identity theft	Other debt	36	6	36	16.67%

Threatened to sue you for very old debt	Credit card debt	59	5	58	8.62%
Didn't receive notice of right to dispute	Credit card debt	66	4	62	6.45%
Seized or attempted to seize your property	Credit card debt	29	2	27	7.41%
Sued you without properly notifying you of lawsuit	I do not know	5	2	5	40.00%
Debt was paid	I do not know	13	2	13	15.38%
Impersonated attorney, law enforcement, or government official	Credit card debt	18	2	17	11.76%
Frequent or repeated calls	Credit card debt	79	2	79	2.53%
Collected or attempted to collect exempt funds	Auto debt	2	2	2	100.00%



The clearest investigation lead identified in the analyst's results is identity-theft complaints involving credit card debt: 372 complaints, 61 untimely responses, 369 known responses, and a 16.53% untimely-response rate. Identity-theft complaints tagged as Other debt have a 16.67% rate (36 complaints, 6 untimely), but the smaller count warrants caution. The identity-theft group tagged as I do not know has 60 complaints, 7 untimely responses, 58 known responses, and a 12.07% rate.

Small-denominator caution: very high rates in groups with only a handful of known responses can be unstable. For example, 2 untimely responses out of 5 known responses gives 40%, and 2 out of 2 gives 100%; those percentages should not be ranked as if they were as reliable as groups with hundreds of responses. The report preserves these rows as part of the analyst's results but does not treat tiny groups as the main basis for prioritization.

7. Recommendations

Route A — Operational investigation and ease of operation

Recommendation: investigate and improve the ease and reliability of account-related operations, especially account opening, account closing, and ongoing account management. Prioritize the account-related complaint themes highlighted in the dashboard: managing an account, closing an account, and trouble during the payment process.

Reasons this route is supported by the analyst's findings:

- Managing an account is the leading category in the dashboard's Top Issues visual.
- Closing an account and trouble during the payment process also appear among the top issue categories.
- Checking or savings account is the largest product group in the analyst's product-level table and has 867 untimely responses, the largest untimely count among the listed products.

Suggested investigation: map the customer journey for account opening, account changes, closure, and payment handling; review complaint narratives for repeated process friction; and validate whether unclear steps, repeated handoffs, delays, or avoidable rework are present. Implement process changes only where the investigation confirms a problem.

Expected direction: reduce preventable account-operation complaints and make account processes easier to complete. This is a proposed outcome, not an impact already demonstrated by the current dataset.

Route B — Data consistency, accuracy, and handling

Recommendation: investigate data consistency and data-handling practices, especially for reported information errors and debt disputes involving identity theft, debts consumers say they do not owe, incorrect amounts, or debts already paid. Where confirmed, improve data validation, record maintenance, information transfer, and correction/escalation procedures.

Reasons this route is supported by the analyst's findings:

- Incorrect information on a report is among the top issues in the Power BI dashboard.
- In debt collection, identity theft involving credit card debt has 372 complaints and a 16.53% untimely-response rate among known responses.
- Other visible debt-collection categories include debt not being the consumer's, attempts to collect the wrong amount, insufficient information to verify debt, and debt reported as paid.

Suggested investigation: trace how account/debt information is created, verified, updated, transferred, and corrected; examine whether records are incomplete, inconsistent, or not updated after disputes or payments; and review handoffs between the original creditor and collector where the available case records allow it. The current analysis does not prove that poor data management caused these complaints, nor does it prove that identity-theft cases inherently take longer to resolve.

Expected direction: reduce complaints caused by confirmed information-quality failures and improve the handling of information disputes. This should be evaluated after any changes rather than assumed in advance.

8. How to validate the recommendations

The current dataset identifies patterns in submitted complaints and response timeliness. It does not contain confirmed root-cause labels or establish whether a complaint was fully resolved to the consumer's satisfaction. The following measures are proposed for post-change monitoring; they are not findings from the current analysis.

Recommendation route	Suggested follow-up measures
Operational investigation	Monthly volume of account-opening, account-closing, account-management, and payment-process complaints; untimely-response count and rate for those categories; comparison before and after process changes.
Data consistency and handling	Monthly volume of incorrect-reporting, identity-theft, debt-not-owed, wrong-amount, and debt-already-paid complaints; untimely-response rate for relevant categories; repeat occurrence of the same issue if a suitable identifier is available.

9. Limitations and interpretation guardrails

- The dataset includes complaints submitted to the CFPB, not all customers or all account interactions.
- Complaint counts do not provide a per-customer risk rate because the number of customers or transactions in each product group is not supplied.
- Timely response is not the same as successful resolution. A Yes value means the response was marked timely, not that the consumer's issue was resolved satisfactorily.
- The dataset does not establish the underlying cause of complaints. References to process friction or data inconsistency are hypotheses to investigate.

- Rates from small groups can fluctuate substantially; review both rates and counts and use minimum sample thresholds when ranking sub-issues.
- In-progress and blank timeliness records are excluded from Yes/No rate denominators.

10. Conclusion

The analyst's findings support two complementary investigation routes. First, investigate account-related operational processes to identify opportunities to make opening, closing, managing, and paying on accounts easier. Second, investigate data consistency and data handling, using reporting errors and debt disputes—particularly the identified identity-theft/credit-card-debt group—as leads for deeper review. The evidence supports investigating these areas; it does not yet establish either root cause. Any operational or data-quality changes should be targeted to problems confirmed during investigation and assessed using complaint counts and response-timeliness measures after implementation.